

Parent Guide — middle / module-03- ayurveda-good-health

IKS Curriculum

Table of Contents

Parent Guide — Module 3: Ayurveda and Good Health

Your child's age: Middle (Grades 6–8) · **Module length:** 10 sessions × 45 min

What your child is learning

The Ayurvedic framework for daily health:

- **Āyurveda** — “the science of life.” A 2000-year-old Indian framework for wellbeing.
- **Swasthya** — wellbeing, defined as physical + mental + social balance.
- **Tridosha** — the three biological energies: **Vāta** (movement; air + space), **Pitta** (transformation; fire + water), **Kapha** (structure; water + earth).
- **Dinacharya** — daily routine: when to wake, eat, exercise, sleep.
- **Ahāra** — food: the six tastes (sweet, sour, salty, pungent, bitter, astringent).

Plus a primary-source verse — **Bhagavad-gītā 6.17** on regulated lifestyle.

How we teach it

The framing is honest: - Ayurveda is a real, ancient, sophisticated framework — especially good for prevention, daily wellbeing, lifestyle. - It is NOT a substitute for modern medicine when acute care is needed. - The Day 3 self-assessment is FOR FUN, not diagnosis.

Important safety note

Nothing in this module is medical advice. If your child has any condition (asthma, allergies, diabetes, mental health, etc.), their existing care continues unchanged. The school will state this clearly. If you have any concern about your child making lifestyle changes, contact us.

What your child will do

- Learn the Tridosha (Vāta, Pitta, Kapha) with examples.
- Try a self-assessment (for fun).
- Design a 7-day dinacharya — their own personal daily routine, with rationale.
- Read BG 6.17 in IAST with translation.
- Present their dinacharya on Day 10.

How to help

Helpful: - Discuss your family's existing wellness habits (regular meal times, sleep schedule, traditional food choices). Many are aligned with dinacharya principles. - For their project: help with realistic scheduling. A dinacharya that fits the actual school day works; one that requires waking at 4am doesn't. - If your family uses any traditional remedies (turmeric milk, etc.), share the family knowledge.

Not helpful: - Pushing dramatic lifestyle changes based on the self-assessment. - Dismissing Ayurveda entirely; some practices ARE supported by modern lifestyle medicine. - Pushing Ayurveda as a substitute for any medication or treatment your child is on.

What success looks like

- Your child can name the three doshas with their elemental basis.
- They can describe dinacharya as a coherent framework, not a random list.
- They have a personal 7-day routine that's realistic for their actual life.
- They can articulate where Ayurveda helps and where modern medicine is essential.

Want to go deeper?

- Wujastyk, D. (2003). *The Roots of Ayurveda*. Penguin. (Accessible adult introduction.)
- Patwardhan, B. et al. (2015). *Integrative Approaches for Health*. Academic Press. (Engages the modern evidence question.)

Senior band (Grade 9–12) goes into classical text reading, the modern evidence base, and integration debates.

10-Day Lesson Plan

Module 3 (Middle) — 10-Day Lesson Plan

Day	Title	File
1	What is Ayurveda?	days/day-01-hook.md
2	The Tridosha	days/day-02-tridosha.md
3	Self-assessment	days/day-03-self-assessment.md
4	Dinacharya	days/day-04-dinacharya.md
5	Mid-module + project	days/day-05-mid-module.md
6	Ahāra — food	days/day-06-ahara.md
7	BG 6.17 primary source	days/day-07-

Day	Title	File
8	Project Session 1	primary-source.md days/day-08-project-session-1.md
9	Project Session 2	days/day-09-project-session-2.md
10	Final + presentation	days/day-10-final-assessment.md

Pacing

- Day 3 self-assessment is FOR FUN, not diagnostic. State this firmly.
- Day 4 dinacharya is the most practical session — protect time.
- Day 10 needs ~4 min per student presenting their dinacharya.

Daily warm-up

Each class opens with: “*Which dosha did you notice most yesterday?*” (mood/energy/food/sleep observation). 2 students share.

What students leave with

- Vocabulary: Ayurveda, Swasthya, dosha, dinacharya.
- The Tridosha framework with examples.
- A personal 7-day dinacharya.
- BG 6.17 in IAST + translation.
- The discipline of distinguishing lifestyle medicine from acute medicine.

Homework

Homework — Module 3 (Middle)

Day	Task	Time
1 → 2	Notice: bedtime, dinner, mood. Take 3 lines of notes.	10 min
2 → 3	Notice: which dosha tendencies do you see in YOURSELF?	10 min
3 → 4	Look up ONE Ayurvedic recommendation for your dominant dosha.	15 min
4 → 5	Pick ONE dinacharya practice. Try it tomorrow.	5 min + practice

Day	Task	Time
5 → 6	Submit project plan (your draft dinacharya).	20 min
6 → 7	Count tastes in your meals tomorrow. Aim for at least 4.	10 min
7 → 8	Pick one of BG 6.17's 5 activities. Notice it tomorrow.	5 min + practice
8 → 9	Try ONE day of your dinacharya. Note what worked.	24 hr practice
9 → 10	Finalise + practise presentation.	20 min